

Pollinator Habitat — Documentation Index

Documentation is organized by audience. Find your role below and start there.

For Conner Prairie Staff (Event Runners)

You run events, hand out QR codes, and look up party size data in the portal after events.

Document	What it covers
Client/CLIENT_GUIDE.md	What the game is, how to run an event, how to use the portal, FAQs

For IT / System Administrators

You deploy the system, manage the server, generate QR codes, and handle backups.

Document	What it covers
Admin/ADMIN_GUIDE.md	Deployment, Docker, networking, session management, backups, troubleshooting, security

For Content Contributors

You update pollinator illustrations without writing code.

Document	What it covers
Contributor/UPDATING_POLLINATOR_IMAGES.md	Step-by-step guide for replacing a pollinator image in the spritesheet

For Software Developers

You write, test, and deploy code. Start with the Overview, then go to the specific guide for the area you're working in.

Getting oriented

Document	What it covers
Developer/HANDOFF.md	Start here if you're taking over — current state, open work, gotchas, quick-start
Developer/OVERVIEW.md	All 3 apps, all pages, all API endpoints, game loop, JWT flow, how to run
Developer/ENV_VARIABLES.md	Every environment variable across all services

Backend

Document	What it covers
Developer/backend-flow.md	Every layer of the backend — startup, routing, handlers, services, Docker
Developer/API_SPECIFICATION.md	All 34 endpoints — exact request/response schemas, auth, error codes
Developer/DATABASE_SCHEMA.md	7-table schema, ER relationships, migration history, seed data
Developer/BACKEND_SERVICES.md	game.service, route.service, utilities, DB operation classes
Developer/NEXT_ROUTE_FLOW.md	Deep trace of route deduplication — cycle algorithm, concurrency handling

Frontend

Document	What it covers
Developer/frontend-flow.md	Page-by-page flow, all services (jwtService, routeService, surveyStorageService), all 19 components
Developer/SHARED_TYPES.md	Route/RouteNode/FactNode interfaces, spritesheet coordinate system
Developer/ACCESSIBILITY.md	localStorage schema, High Contrast CSS, TTS setting, Font Size Slider

Portal

Document	What it covers
Developer/PORTAL_FLOW.md	Portal state/logic, all components, fetch services, env vars, testing

Infrastructure

Document	What it covers
Developer/DOCKER_SETUP.md	All 4 compose files, all Dockerfiles, Nginx config, env vars, troubleshooting

Content & Routes

Document	What it covers
Developer/ADDING_ROUTES.md	Seed file structure, spritesheet coordinates, adding routes, re-seeding

Testing

Document	What it covers
Developer/TEST_DOCUMENTATION.md	How to run tests; per-test documentation for all 37 test files

Route statistics

Document	What it covers
Developer/ROUTE_STATISTICS_SPEC.md	Feature spec — 10 route metrics, 20 endpoints  backend complete, portal UI  pending
Developer/ROUTE_STATS_API_REFERENCE.md	API reference for all 20 statistics endpoints

Architecture decisions

Document	What it covers
Developer/MYSQL_LICENSE_ISSUE.md	Why PostgreSQL is required for production deployment

Folder Structure

docs/	
README.md	← this file
Developer/	← software developers
Admin/	← IT / operations staff
Client/	← Conner Prairie event staff
Contributor/	← non-technical content editors